



ture will assist our business and bring in scale. We are present in 125 destinations across the world and good connectivity [in India] augurs well for our business.

Q: Obviously, the scale that you possess is a huge advantage...

A: Yes, our corporate overhead as a percentage of sales has steadily been going down. As you become more efficient with operations, that number goes straight to the bottom line. We have 188 properties today. That said, there is still pressure on costs and now with business coming back, the cost of hiring too has gone up. We suffered a lot less, but the fact is that salary costs are higher. We are probably among the

few players in hospitality that paid both parts of the salary component—the fixed portion and the variable [during the Covid-19 pandemic].

Q: How have skill sets in your industry changed over time? One constantly hears of a talent shortage across sectors.

A: People knew their guests in the past but these days, a lot has changed. Gadgets are a big thing and that is a generational change.

The question is, what are we doing as an organisation? All our key employees don't retire completely. They are involved in areas like conducting heritage walks; [some] played a part in relaunching The Cham-